Session 10

2025-04-13

1 - Prayer or blood

~11:00, 26 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. In the cave entrance the party has Eguzkilore's body laid down — Nyx, still disguised as a kobold, struggles to say it plainly: *he is gone*. Inside the temple of Tiamat, Amidamaru is sprawled out cold, barely breathing. Mialee, in kobold form, is nearby.
2. Nuberroca won't leave Eguzkilore lying there and bundles the body across his back with rope, slung like a pack.
3. The barbarian, *bleeding*, then asks Sinsong to heal him before he runs back inside. Sinsong demands prayer first: *"levanta las manos y grita 'Sinsong'"*. Nuberroca grabs him by the head and presses back — *"¿Por qué te tengo que rezar? ¿Quién eres tú? ¿Y por qué tienes esas marcas en la cabeza?"*. Sinsong's pitch: *"Soy una persona que cree que se pueden hacer las cosas bien, pero para eso necesito amigos que puedan acompañarme en este viaje"*.
4. Nyx breaks off, out of patience — *"estáis hablando mucho y no estáis haciendo nada"*. When Sinsong finally moves, he heals Nyx instead — *the one within easy reach* — leaving Nuberroca unhealed.
5. Sinsong folds an *emboldening bond* across the party. Nyx dashes into the cave to reach Amidamaru and Mialee; Sinsong sets off last and, with the others already out of sight, loses the trail in the dark.
6. Inside, Mialee slips Amidamaru a *healing potion* from his own belt-pouch; the tortle stirs, *back from the threshold*. She then turns and runs a clean blade through the kobold beside her — dropping all pretense. The wounded kobold can't square it — *a kobold striking a kobold* is *anathema* to their mentality — and the pack closes on her at once, blades finding the gaps from every side.
7. Amidamaru, on his feet again, brings his *infused* blade through the nearest kobold — *the strike kills, and green fire skips off the corpse to scorch the kobold beside it*. One down, one burning.
8. The kobold pack focuses on Amidamaru — blows landing from every angle as they close in, every swing finding home. **The tortle drops again**. Mialee, alone now against the remaining kobolds, slips behind a column to hide, but a kobold tracks her, *finds her*, and lands a clean hit. **She goes down.**

2 - Gruesome rescue

1. Nuberroca reaches the shaft that drops to the Tiamat chamber and takes the descent the fast way — he steps off the edge without doubt, twists in mid-air, and catches enough rope to soften the landing. The fall stings, but the blood-fury already roaring through him swallows the worst of it.
2. The goliath dissolves into *a swirl of cloud* and re-forms at Amidamaru's shoulder thirty feet across the chamber. Then he recognizes Mialee too — *choking on her own blood, gasping for breath*. He has barely a step left to reach her, but there is a kobold in his way.
3. ***[EPIC]*** Nuberroca *hurls Eguzkilore's body at the kobold pressing Mialee* to clear his path — the off-balance throw goes wide and the body slams into the stone floor. *A sickening crack as an arm folds back in an unnatural way; teeth snap loose against the stone; a slow line of blood draws across the floor from the elf's slack mouth.*
4. Ignoring the kobold, the barbarian takes another step, pulls the bandages and salves from his belt-pouch and works on Mialee until her breathing steadies.
5. Nyx kneels beside Amidamaru and presses one of her *berries* into his mouth in a single quick motion. The tortle's eyes open again.
6. The last kobold breaks for the door. Nuberroca's greataxe meets it at the edge of the chamber — *the kobold's pieces tumble on the floor*. The fight is over.

3 - The lone explorer

~11:30, 26 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. Nuberroca scoops Mialee and Eguzkilore up onto his shoulders — the elves are slight against the goliath's bulk — and climbs the rope back up the shaft to **Mondath's quarters** above, his clothes still aglow from Sinsong's *light* cantrip. Eguzkilore's body dangles on his back, the broken arm jutting wrong under the rope, blood gone tacky on Nuberroca's shirt where the elf presses.
2. Nyx, still in her kobold-disguise, follows behind, slipping a *berry* into Mialee's mouth as they walk — *"en mi tribu me enseñaron que no se deja ningún hombre atrás"*. Mialee comes around against Nuberroca's shoulder.
3. Inside the room, the goliath drags one of the low shelves across the doorway as a *barricade*. Mialee calls **Echo** — her bat familiar — but the bat is dead, killed when Mialee activated the acid trap in the statue chamber.
4. Sinsong, meanwhile, had been exploring alone — the party had run too far ahead for him to follow. He descended the ramped corridor past the remains of the *purple fungi*, reached a high-ceilinged cave *alive with bats*, the floor *thick with guano*, scattered with *desiccated bat corpses*. Past it he heard heavy footfalls and a growling deeper down; he called for the others without answer and turned back the way he came.
5. Coming back towards the cave's entrance Sinsong sees a kobold — *Nyx, still in disguise, searching for him* — and lulls it into slumber, mistaking her for an enemy. As he reaches in to check the kobold's body he notices something off — *the body doesn't match what his hands are telling him*. He grapples her and shakes the slumber loose. *"Sinsong, cabrón. Que soy yo. Soy Nyx"*. *"¡Hostia, Nyx!"*. He apologises and lets her go.
6. The party settles in to catch their breath behind the barricade — an hour of quiet. **Munin**, Amidamaru's summoned owl, takes the watch. Nyx and Mia pull off their kobold-form at last and the halfling steps over to slip a *berry* into Eguzkilore's *pocket*.
7. Nyx finally reads the papers she grabbed from Mondath's desktop. *A map* of the Greenfields — *arrows from the towns the cult has hit, all bending west toward Beregost and then north*. A side note: *all goods to be freighted north to Naerytar*. The other papers: Rezmir — *the wirmspeaker* — has *permitted* them to keep some pearls and small valuables; dry camp logistics of no use to the party — *watch rotations, ration counts*; and, *a handful of bad dragon poems*.
8. After resting, Sinsong approaches Nuberroca weaving a prayer of healing through his palm, and the goliath, recovered, thanks him.

4 - The last egg

1. Sinsong wants the *third dragon egg* — the one Mialee set on fire — destroyed before they leave. *Smash the egg, then revive him*, he proposes. Nuberroca agrees on the first part.
2. The party descends back to the egg chamber. Sinsong opens with a *bolt of light* at the shell — it strikes home but the egg holds. He follows with a *fire bolt*; still no crack.
3. Nuberroca steps up and brings his *greataxe* down on the shell — a small crack opens. He follows with the *greatsword*, driving the blade through the breach. *Inside, the dragonling cries out in agony, then falls silent*. Acid washes over the blade as he draws it free — *the blade holds, but the acid scores marks into the steel*.
4. Nuberroca then takes some straw and uses the acid to *etch the rune he wears on his belt* into both the greatsword's blade and the axe-head. *There — that's my writing.*

5 - Strange offerings

1. *"¿Volvemos por la ruta pintoresca o la corta?"* — Nuberroca lays out what he knows of the cave's north end from his previous exploration. Past the bat cave is a chamber with *troglodytes*, and beside it *another chamber with drake-sound from inside*. Mialee and Nyx push to leave — they have what they came for, Eguzkilore needs the *cleric in Greenest*, the cave's western route they know is clear.
2. Nuberroca wants to check the *kobold quarters* — the burrow the reinforcements had streamed in from — and heads in ahead of the group, Eguzkilore's body left lying on the ground behind him. Nyx starts to follow for support, but the ambush comes first — *two kobolds drop from the ceiling*, surprising him, one scoring a hit as it lands. The kobolds scuttle out through a wall-gap before he can chase. Nuberroca picks his way around the empty chamber: *no traps*, and at the back, a strange offering pile.
3. *88 small piles of 8 copper coins each*, surrounded by *scattered gold and silver — that smells ritual*, Nyx says quietly. Mounded against the wall is a heap of *dragon-amulets* — most are shoddy, whittled wooden things, but one is heavier, *worked in gold*. Nuberroca takes the gold amulet and scoops the coin-piles together.

6 - The drake nursery

1. They follow Nuberroca's route — north out through the cave-in he had triggered on his way out the previous trip. Sinsong walks across first, the rocks above holding. *Then a fresh fall comes down* — most of it crashes around Nuberroca, opening a fresh gash across his shoulder and a cut over his temple; *a soft blue glow flickers across him and the wounds close* as he walks on. A chip of stone catches Mialee on the shoulder right behind him.
2. Sinsong, *impatient*, runs ahead. He slips down into the floor of *the next chamber* before the others can call him back. The room is large and *deeper than the corridor* — a pit ringed by climbing walls, with *broken humanoid mannequins* against the back wall, *bite-marks worn through them*. *Three drakes* jump on him — smaller than the others they have seen, but together they pose a serious threat.
3. Sinsong scrambles for the lip of the pit, scaling the rough side as the drakes lunge after him. One catches him as he climbs — *claw across the back*. The party closes in from the corridor mouth. Nuberroca finds the pit's edge thanks to his magic light and opens the iron gate at the top. Amidamaru runs through into the dark behind him. *Nyx climbs onto the lip from the side*, scrambling up the rough wall hand-over-foot without slowing.
4. Mialee, perched above the pit on the corridor lip, threads an arrow straight into the lead drake's *eye* — the shot lands true from above. *The beast reels*, blood streaming where the arrow stands.
5. Sinsong's body lights up with *celestial radiance*, light pouring from him to fill the pit, his bald head glowing. He calls a *prayer of healing* on himself as the drakes claw at him, his wounds emitting a soft red glow as they knit together. The drakes flinch from the radiance as it begins to *scorch them*.
6. Munin the owl drifts over the pit, perching on the dwarf's shoulder to *deliver a healing spell* — the worst of the claw-wounds seals shut. Mialee sends a second shaft into the staggering lead drake from above; Nuberroca's axe-swing at the same beast goes wide.
7. Nyx, with her last arrow, fires at the reeling drake she had been tracking; the drake falls. Her eye is on the next before her arm has lowered.
8. Sinsong steps in with a *necrotic touch* on the closest drake — the attack lands, while the radiance *scorches it*, but it stays on its feet. *"De nada, Sinsong, por curarte"* — mutters Amidamaru.
9. Nuberroca brings the greataxe down on it — the blow lands clean, shredding the drake through, and the beast falls.
10. Amidamaru, from the upper lip, snaps a *fire bolt* at the last surviving drake.
11. ***[EPIC]*** Nyx pulls two arrows from a *fallen drake's carcass*, sets one on the bow, and threads the shot into the last drake. As the arrow strikes, a single swing of Nuberroca's *greatsword* finishes the work.

7 - The cold storage

~12:00, 26 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. A short corridor links the drake nursery to the bat cave. Crossing it, Sinsong steps on a *soft, leathery tile that gives under his weight* — a needle bites up through his sandal into his sole, leaving him a little *light-headed*. On the cave's east side, a curtain of leather strips hangs across an opening.
2. Mialee scans the floor ahead and finds more of the same — *soft, leathery tiles* in the floor beneath; the leather gives under weight and lets the needles, coated in some greenish fluid, bite up through the sole. With Nyx steadying her, she packs sand and dirt into the space beneath each tile until the leather can no longer give.
3. Past the bat cave they reach the leather-strip curtain. Several of the strips are *threaded with fishhooks dipped in some darker liquid*. Mialee calls up her *unseen hand* and lifts the strips clear from above so the party can walk through unsnagged; Amidamaru raises a second hand to mirror her.
4. The room beyond *stinks of rot* and is colder than the rest of the cave. *Chains and meat-hooks* hang between the pillars; some carry *animal carcasses, several fresh, some long past*. The cult's *cold storage*. *Nothing of use* among the tools. They go back and continue to the exit.
5. The party clears the cave's outer mouth in silence. The walk back to Greenest is *four hours by foot*; with Eguzkilore's body on Nuberroca's back the count comes to *five hours*. The road is uneventful.

8 – Briefing at the Keep

~17:00, 26 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. Inside Greenest keep, Nyx lays the *map and notes* on **Tarbaw Nighthill**'s table. He reads the *Greenfields chart* with the arrows bending west — *this is genuinely important* — and confirms they should carry the find to **Leosin** at **Elturel**, where Leosin is bound. He promises to send *the same warning* to every contact the keep can reach, especially along *Beregost*. Tarbaw counts out *50 gold pieces* from his own purse as a thank-you.
2. Mialee shows Tarbaw the *ring* she lifted from the cult cave the night before — a gold band with a worked stone. Tarbaw recognises it: *the Dolenza Zirrine* of Greenfields, *one of the richer families in town, robbed in the raid*. He arranges its return — *250 gold pieces* as the family's thanks. *"Estoy orgulloso de ti, Mialee"* — says Nuberroca, his hand on her shoulder.
3. Nuberroca asks for a final favour — *the cleric* who revived Sinsong, *can he raise their fallen?* Tarbaw writes them a letter of recommendation asking whoever reads it to *help them save their companion*. The cleric will be at the *Temple of Chauntea* if not at *the dragon's mansion* north of the keep.
4. **Escobert the Red** receives Cyanwrath's head a moment later — *Nuberroca brought it on his belt*. Escobert grins and asks if he may *mount it on the castle gate*. Nuberroca agrees, on one condition: *"me gustaría que se recordase que el último golpe se le di yo". We'll put your name on a plaque*, Escobert grins back. Later, Nyx pulls Nuberroca aside — *it was actually one of her arrows that landed the kill* — but she lets the story stand for Escobert's sake.
5. Tarbaw also presses the party for *resupply* — arrows, axes, rations, all the gear they had used up; Nyx asks for arrows above all. He lends them *nine horses* — one each for the six of them, plus **Miguel** as escort and *two guards* for the road north, on condition Miguel return the horses afterward.

9 – The diamond

~18:00?, 26 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. The cleric — *the same one who had brought Sinsong back* — greets them at the temple. He looks at Eguzkilore's body and asks the only question that matters: *How long has it been?*. The party debates aloud — *the night's full rest at the bat cave fell before Eguzkilore died, not after* — and the count comes out to *seven hours since the death*. *Raise Dead* is on the table.
2. The cost: a *pure diamond, at least five hundred gold pieces*, burned into the rite itself; *2,500 gold pieces* for the casting, knocked down to *1,700 on Tarbaw's letter* and further to *1,500* in the final negotiation. The party has neither the diamond nor that much coin.
3. They cross the keep to the only *jeweller's* in Greenest — **Bryert**, *a smug, well-dressed man* with the bearing of money. Sinsong, who had laid *guidance* over Nyx for the bargaining, betrays the spell mid-pitch — the quiet syllables and finger-traces no jeweller's eye would miss. The pitch goes flat anyway: *If you want to buy things, this is a shop. The prices are clearly marked*.
4. ***[EPIC]*** Mialee, watching the count, lays five *worked gems* she had been holding on the counter — *roughly five hundred gold pieces' worth* between them — and asks plainly to trade them straight across for one of his diamonds. The pitch lands cleaner than Sinsong's ever did — *Bryert agrees: the gems for one of his diamonds*. Mialee also picks up *a small 75-gp diamond for Amidamaru* before they leave.

10 – Eguzkilore restored

~19:00?, 26 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. Back at the temple the party pools every coin they carry. The total stops at *1,334 gold* — still short. *Cero*, Nuberroca says of his own purse. He turns Eguzkilore over and tips out the elf's coin too. *If money's what brings him back — damn the cost, take it*.
2. The cleric calls the rite over the diamond. *Eguzkilore comes back barely conscious, unable to speak*. The party gathers in close. *At last, at last, brother* — Nuberroca, taking the elf in his arms. Sinsong follows up with a *healing* to lift him further from the edge.
3. The cleric warns Eguzkilore that he will move *slower than usual* for the next several days — his every effort dulled until the resurrection settles. The party walks the elf the short way back to the keep.
4. Inside, they share a quiet dinner together and, wrung out from the day, retire to their rooms — the night carries them.